

Mottoes

University Mottos:

Amherst College- Terras irradiant. ("Let them illuminate the earth.")
Baylor University – Pro ecclesia, pro Texana ("for church, for Texas")
Brooklyn College- Nil sine magno labore. ("Nothing without great effort.")
Brown University- In Deo speramus. ("In God we trust.")
Catholic University of America - Deus lux Mea ("God is my light")
City College of NY- Respice, adspice, prospice. ("Look back, look to the present, look to the future.")
Columbia University- In lumine tuo videbimus lumen. ("In thy light, we shall see light.")
Dartmouth College- Vox clamantis in deserto. ("A voice of one crying in the wilderness.")
Fordham University- Sapientia et doctrina. ("Wisdom and knowledge.")
George Washington University- Deus nobis fiducia ("God is our trust")
Harvard University- Veritas. ("Truth.")
Hunter College- Mihi cura futuri. ("My anxiety is for the future.")
Indiana University Bloomington – Lux et Veritas ("light and truth")
Johns Hopkins University- Veritas vos liberabit. ("Truth will free you.")
Miami University of Ohio- Prodesse quam conspici. ("To the productive, rather than to be ornamental.")
New York University- Perstare et praestare. ("To preserve and to surpass")
Northwestern University – quaecum sunt vera ("whatever is true")
Notre Dame University- crux spes unica ("The cross is the only hope")
Oxford University – Dominus illuminatio mea ("the lord is my light")
Princeton University- Dei sub numine viget ("It flourishes under the will of God")
The Jesuit: ad maiorem dei gloriam ("For the greater glory of God")
Trinity College- Pro ecclesia et patria. ("For church and country.")
Tulane University- Non sibi, sed suis. ("Not for herself, but for her own.")
Tufts University – Pax et Lux ("Peace and Light")
Univ. Florida- Civium in moribus rei publicae salus. ("In the character of its citizens lies the welfare of the state.")
University of Chicago- crescat scientia, vita excolatur (Let knowledge increase, let life be perfected)
University of California – fiat lux ("let there be light")
University of Georgia – Et docere et rerum exquirere causas ("both to teach & to inquire into the causes of things")
University of Michigan- Artes, scientia, veritas. ("The arts, knowledge, truth.")
University of Mississippi- Virtute et armis. ("By valor and arms.")
University of Missouri- Salus populi. ("The welfare of the people.")
University of Nebraska- Litteris dedicata et omnibus artibus ('Dedicated to letters and all the arts')
University of New Mexico- Lux hominum vita. ("Light of the life of men.")
University of Oklahoma – Civi et rei publicae ("for the citizen and the state")
University of Oregon- Mens agitat molem ('Mind moves the mass')
University of Pennsylvania – Leges sine moribus vanae – ("laws without morals are useless")
University of Texas- disciplina praesidium civitatis ("Instruction is the safeguard of the state")
University of the South(Sewanee)- Ecce quam bonam ("Behold how good")
University of Vermont- Studiis et rebus honestis ("by honorable pursuits and deeds")
University of Washington- Lux sit. ("Let there be light.")
Wake Forest University – Pro Humanitate ("For humanity")
Washington University – per virtutem vis ("strength through virtue")
Yale University- Lux et veritas. ("Light and truth.")

State Mottos:

Alabama- Audemus iura nostra defendere ('we dare defend our rights')
Arizona- Ditat Deus ("God enriches")
Arkansas- Regnat Populus ("The people rule")
California- Eureka! ("I've found it!")
Colorado- Nil sine numine ("Nothing without God")
Connecticut- Qui transtulit sustinet ("He who came across, holds up.")
District of Columbia- Iustitia omnibus ("Justice for all.")
Idaho- Esto perpetua ("Be always")
Kansas- ad astra per aspera ("To the stars through difficulties")
Kentucky – Deo gratiam habeamus ("Let us be grateful to god")
Maine- Dirigo ("I direct.")
Maryland- crescite et multiplicamini ("increase and multiply")
Massachusetts- Ense petit placidam sub libertate quietem ("With the sword he seeks peace under liberty")
Michigan- Si quaeris peninsulam amoenam, circumspice ("If you seek a pleasant peninsula, look around")
Minnesota- civitas successit barbarum ("Civilization succeeds barbarism")
Mississippi- Virtute et armis ("By courage and arms")
Missouri- Salus populi suprema lex esto. ("Let the welfare of the people be the supreme law.")
New Mexico- Crescit eundo ("It grows as it goes")
New York- Excelsior! ("Higher!")
North Carolina- Esse quam videri ("To be rather than to seem")
Oklahoma- Labor omnia vincit ("Work conquers all")
Puerto Rico- Joannes est nomen eius ("John is his name.")
Ohio – Imperium in imperio ("an empire within an empire")
Oregon- Alis volat propriis (S/he Flies With Her/His Own Wings)
South Carolina- dum spiro, spero ("While I breathe, I hope")
Virginia- Sic semper tyrannis. ("Thus always to Tyrants")
West Virginia- montani semper liberi. ("Mountaineers are always free")
Wyoming- cedant arma togae ("Let arms yield to the toga")

Major Cities

Boston- Sicut patribus, sit Deus nobis ("As to our fathers, may God be to us")
Chicago- Urbs in horto ("City in a Garden")
Detroit – speramus meliora, resurget cineribus ("we hope for better things, it will rise from the ashes")
London- Domine, dirige nos ("Lord, guide us")
Paris – Fluctuat nec mergitur ("It is tossed by the waves but does not sink")

Military Latin Mottos:

Marine Corps- semper fidelis ("Always faithful")
Coast Guard- semper paratus - ("Always ready")
The Royal Air Force- Per ardua ad astra ("Through struggle to the stars")

Other:

Metro- Goldwyn - Mayer logo - ars artis gratia- ('art for the sake of art')
Society of Jesuits – Ad maiorem dei gloriam ("for the greater glory of god")
Epicureans – Dum vivimus vivamus ("while we live let us live")
1\$ Bill - Novus Ordo Seclorum ('A new order of the ages')
1\$ Bill- Annuit Coeptis ('He looks with favor on our undertakings')
U.S. Money- e pluribus unum ('from many, one' or 'out of many, one')
Olympics – Citius, altius, fortius ("faster, higher, stronger")

Abbreviations

Tombstone Abbreviations:

R.I.P. – Requiescat in Pace ('may he rest in peace')

H.J.S. – Hic iacet sepultus ('here lies buried')

S.T.T.L. (sit tibi terra levis) – may the earth rest lightly on you

D.M. – Dis minimus (to the spirits of the dead)

Medical Terms:

a.c. -(ante cibos) before meals

b.i.d (bis in die) twice a day

gtt. (guttae) drops

h.s.- (hora somni) -at bedtime

o.d.-(oculus dexter) right eye

o.s.-(oculus sinister) left eye

p.c. (post cibos)- after meals

p.o. – per os ('orally')

q.d. (quaque die) everyday

q.s. (quantum sufficiat) -as much as needed

quot.- daily

Rx -(recipe) – take

s.i.d. (semel in die)- once a day

stat. (statim) immediately

t.i.d.- (ter in die) three times a day

Simple Abbreviations:

A.D. (anno domini)- in the year of our lord

A.M. (ante meridiem)- before midday

a.u.c. (ab urbe condita, anno urbis conditae)- from the founding of the city

Cet. Par.- with other things being equal

cf. (confer)- compare

d.s.p. (decessit sine prole)- dead without issue

D.V. (Deo volente)- god willing

e.g. (exempli gratia)-for [the sake of an] example

et al.-(et alia)- and others

et seq. – and the following

etc.- (et cetera)- and so forth, and the rest

F.D. (fidei defensor) – defender of the faith (a title of the British monarchs)

ff. (foliis)-on the [following] pages

fl. (floruit) – period of time during which a person or thing flourished

f.r. (folio recto) – on the right-hand page

f.v. (folio verso) – on the left hand page

i.e. (id est)-that is

ibid. (ibidem) – in the same place

Infra. dig (infra dignitatem)- beneath one's dignity

loc. cit. (loco citato) – in a previously cited place

m.o. (modus operandi) – way of operating

mod.- medium

P.M. (post meridiem)-after midday

p.r.n. (pro re nata)- as the need arises
pass. (passim) - everywhere
pinx. (pinxit) – he painted
p.s. - written after
Q. E. D.-(quod erat demonstrandum) that which was to be shown
sc. (scilicet) – actually
S.C.U. (Senatus Consultum Ultimum)- Final decree of the senate (marital law)
s.g.- without example
s.o.s. (si opus sit) – if there is need
S.P.Q.R. (Senatus Populusque Romanus)- The Senate and the Roman People
v.i. (vide infra) – see below
v.s. (vide super)- see above
viz. (videlicet)- namely
vs. (versus) – against

Phrases

Colloquial Sayings:

ab imo pectore – from the bottom of the heart
ad kalendas graecas – never / when hell freezes over (literally “at the greek calends”)
aut viam inveniam aut faciam – where there’s a will there’s a way (lit. “either I’ll find a way or make one”)
De gustibus non est disputandum – there is no accounting for taste
De mortuis nil nisi bonum -- speak only good of the dead
rem acu tetigisti – you hit the nail on the head

Other Phrases:

a dextra- on the right
a posteriori – from effect to cause (lit. “from what comes after”)
a priori – from what is already known (lit. “from what comes before”)
ab initio – from the beginning
ab ovo usque ad mala -- from the egg to the apple (“from beginning to end” like “from soup to nuts”)
ad gustum- to one's taste
ad hoc – for this purpose
ad hominem – against the man
Ad infinitum -- without end
Ad nauseam -- to the point of disgust
Alma mater -- nourishing mother -- for any school/college
alter ego – another self
aqua vitae – whiskey / alcohol
Bona fide -- in good faith
Casus Belli- justification for war
Cave canem- beware the dog
Caveat emptor -- let the buyer beware
Cum grano salis -- with a grain of salt (i.e. use caution)
curriculum vitae – resume
De facto -- in fact; actually
De jure -- by right; legally
deus ex machina – an unlikely and providential intervention
Ex tempore- without preparation
Gaudeamus igitur- therefore, let us rejoice

Habeas corpus: a writ to bring a detained person before a judge (lit. you must have the body)

In absentia -- in absence

In aeternum- forever

in loco parentis -- in the place of a parent

in medias res -- in the middle of things

in memoriam -- in memory of

In vino veritas- In wine, the truth

ipso facto -- by the very fact itself

lapsus linguae -- a slip of the tongue

modus operandi: a method of working

mutatis mutandis – with the necessary changes having been made

Ne plus ultra- perfection

Non compos mentis- an unsound man

Per annum -- by the year

Per capita -- by heads

Per diem -- by the day

Per se -- by itself; essentially

Persona non grata -- an unwelcome person

post mortem – autopsy

post partum – after childbirth

Quantum- how much

quid pro quo -- something for something

Similis veri- probable

sine die -- indefinitely; without setting a day

Sine mora- without delay

sine qua non – an indispensable condition; a necessity

sine prole – without children

Status quo- existing condition

Sub rosa- secretly

sui generis – one of a kind

Suo motu- spontaneously

tabula rasa – a clean slate

tempus fugit – time flies

Usque ad- all the way up to

vade mecum -- a constant companion (go with me)

vae victis – woe to the conquered

verbatim -- word for word

via -- by way of

vice versa: the other way around

Quotations

Augustus

“*Festina lente*” – make haste slowly

“*Acta est fabula*” – the story is finished

Caesar

“*Veni, vidi, vici*” – I came, I saw, I conquered (after the battle of Zela)

“*Alea iacta est*” – the die is cast (before crossing the Rubicon)

Cato the Elder

“*Delenda est Carthago*” – Carthage must be destroyed

Constantine

“*In hoc signo vinces*” - in this sign you will conquer

Descartes

“*Cogito ergo sum*” – I think therefore I am

Horace

“*Carpe diem, quam minimum credula postero*” – seize the day, trusting as little as possible in tomorrow

“*Dulce et decorum est pro patria mori*” – There’s no greater honor than to die for one’s country

“*Eheu fugaces labuntur anni*” – alas, the fleeting years glide by

“*Exegi monumentum aere perennius*” – I have raised a monument more lasting than bronze

“*parturient montes, nascetur ridiculus mus*” – all that work and nothing to show for it

Juvenal

“*Difficile est saturam non scribere*” – it is not difficult to write satire

“*Mens sana in corpore sano*” - a sound mind in a sound body

“*Panem et circenses*” – bread and circus games

“*Quis custodiet ipsos custodes*” – who will guard the guards themselves?

Nero

“*Qualis artifex pereo*” – what in artist dies in me

Ovid

“*Rident stolidi verba Latina*” – fools laugh at the Latin language

“*Tempus edax rerum*” – time, the devourer of all things

Seneca

“*Errare humanum est*” – to err is human

Tiberius

“*Oderint dum metuant*” – let them hate provided that they fear